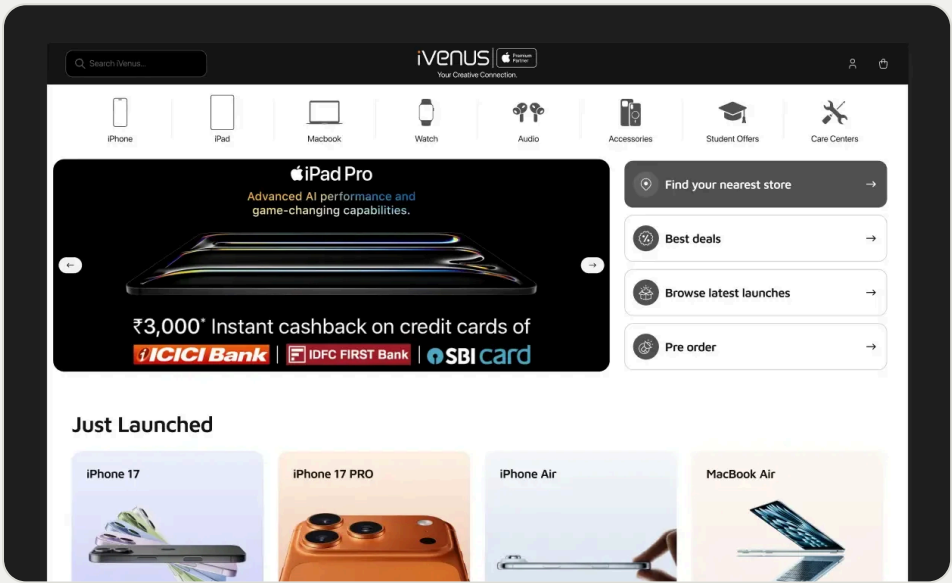


Designing the bridge between iVenus online and in-store.

What began as an e-commerce redesign for a premium Apple Partner became a study in one question: how do we keep a customer oriented as they move between a screen and a shop?

- Role: UI/UX Designer
- E-commerce / Omnichannel UX
- Platform: Web
- UX · UI · Product Design



Redesigned homepage: category nav, hero offer, and “Find your nearest store” as a first-class entry point.

MAIN CHALLENGE

Connect discovery, decision, location, availability, payment and store interaction without the customer losing context.

SCOPE

iVenus has online commerce and physical stores. The design had to carry a premium, Apple-oriented look and still work as practical e-commerce.

01 The starting point

02 The challenge

03 Problem & themes

04 Behavioural personas

05 Customer journey

06 Friction points

07 Information architecture

08 Product detail page

09 Location UX

10 Online vs store

11–12 Booking & states

13–15 Checkout, failure, confirmation

16–17 Trust & principles

18–19 Evolution & before/after

26 Reflection

The old store looked dated, felt slow and was hard to follow.

iVenus sells premium Apple products, but the original site didn't feel premium. It was outdated, slow, confusing and, more than anything, difficult to buy from.

Outdated

Dense banners, mismatched type and inconsistent buttons. It looked nothing like the products it sold.

Slow

Heavy, unoptimised images made pages feel like they stalled, especially on mobile connections.

Confusing

Unclear product names, buried specs, and no obvious difference between similar variants.

Bad UX

Checkout asked for everything up front. Nothing told you what happened after you paid.

EXAMPLES OF THE PATTERNS I SAW

Competing homepage banners

Five offers fought for attention, so the customer couldn't tell where to start.

Specs without comparison

To compare two phones you had to open both and memorise the differences.

The store was a separate world

Store details lived on their own page, disconnected from any product.

A silent finish

After payment there was no clear status, which left people wondering if it worked.

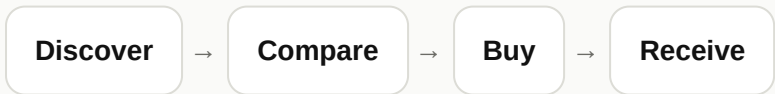
Illustrative examples of the problem patterns, not a measured audit or performance data.

A visual refresh alone wouldn't have fixed this. The site was confusing in ways that no amount of polish could hide.

This wasn't a conventional e-commerce redesign.

A standard shop ends at the doorstep. iVenus often ends at a counter, which adds decisions the customer has never had to make on a normal store site.

TRADITIONAL E-COMMERCE



IVENUS



The extra four stages are where uncertainty lives, so they are where the design effort went.

03 — PROBLEM DEFINITION

Customers needed to move between digital and physical without losing context.

They had to understand what happens next at every step.

Discovery Finding and comparing products.	Decision making Configuring, understanding price.	Location Why it's needed, how to set it.	Availability Confidence the product exists nearby.
Transaction Buy online, or pay a minimum and the balance in store.	Store interaction Booking, pickup, visit.	Communication Status, confirmation, follow-up.	Trust GST, payment, clear outcomes.

04 — UNDERSTANDING THE USER

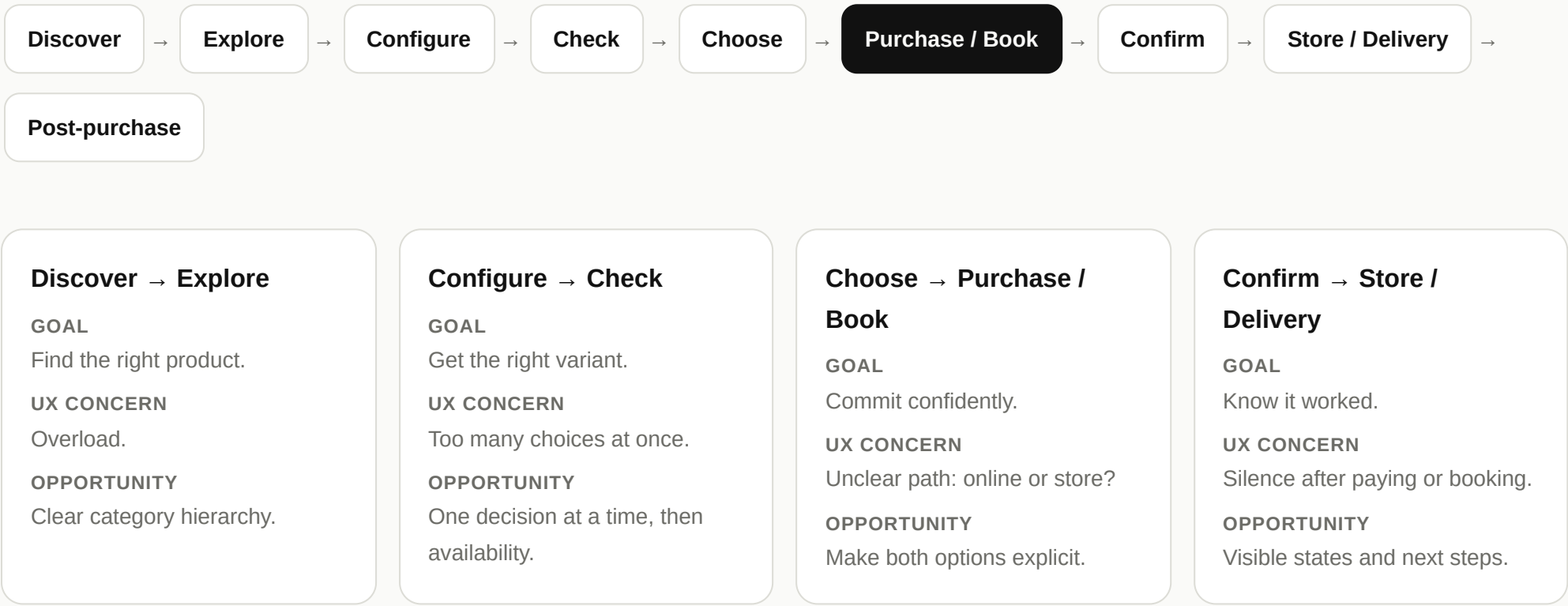
Four behaviours, not four demographics.

No demographic data was available, so I framed users by what they're trying to do.

The Researcher Compares specs before buying. NEED Depth without noise. FRICTION Buried specs, unclear differences. REQUIREMENT Structured, scannable product info.	The Convenience Buyer Knows what they want. NEED The fastest route to pay. FRICTION Extra questions before checkout. REQUIREMENT Short, progressive checkout.	The Store-Oriented Buyer Wants to see or collect in store. NEED A way to reserve with confidence. FRICTION Website feels disconnected from the store. REQUIREMENT Visible store booking path and states.	The Deal-Seeker Chasing current offers. NEED Location-specific offers and availability. FRICTION Not knowing why location is asked. REQUIREMENT Location explained as a benefit.
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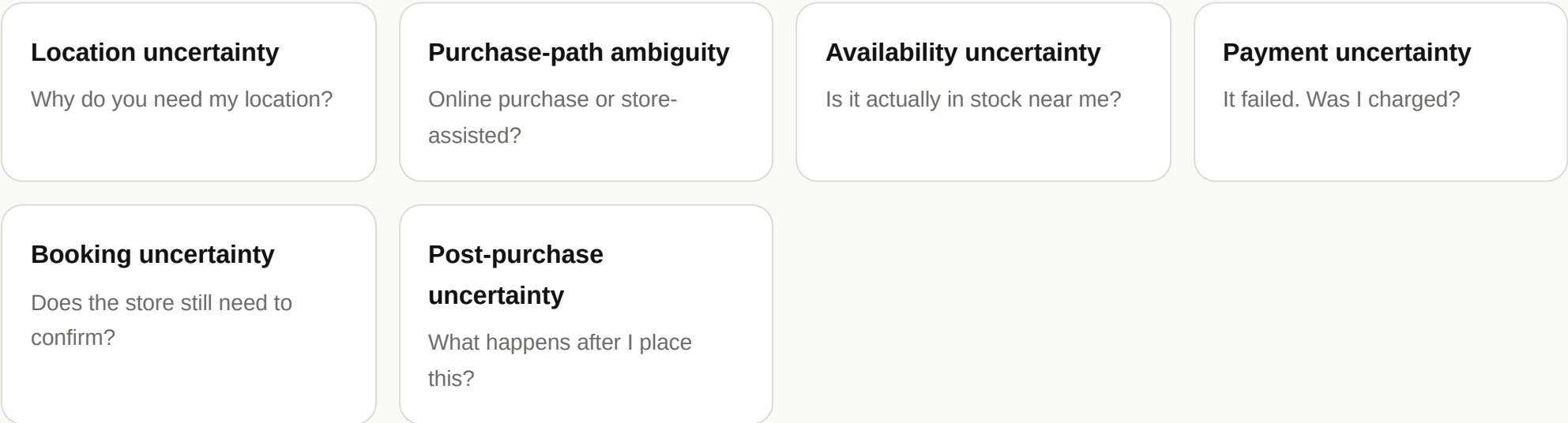
05 – CUSTOMER JOURNEY

Nine stages, each with a job to do.



06 – FRICTION MAP

Six places where customers get stuck.



Almost none of these are visual problems. They're all moments where the system knew something and the customer didn't.

07 – INFORMATION ARCHITECTURE

Structure that follows the decision, not the org chart.

HOME (ivenus.in)

└─ Products ─ iPhone · iPad · Mac · Watch · Music · Accessories

/product-category/...

└─ Hot deals

/hotdeals

└─ New arrivals

/new-arrival

└─ Product Detail

/product/...

└─ Configuration · Availability · Store Selection · Purchase / Booking

└─ Cart → Checkout ─ Customer Details · GST · Delivery / Pickup · Payment

└─ Account · Orders

/my-account

└─ Find a Store

/find-a-store

└─ Care Centers

/service-center

08 – PRODUCT DETAIL PAGE

Progressive decision-making, top to bottom.

1 Understand product

→

2 Understand price

→

3 Configure

→

4 Check availability

→

5 Select purchase method

→

6 Complete

The order matters: a customer shouldn't be asked to choose a purchase method before they know the price, or check a store before they've picked a variant.

[Product imagery + specs]

iPhone — name & headline

Price

₹ — 2

Colour / Storage

Select 3

Available at your store?

Check 4 6

Buy online · Book at store

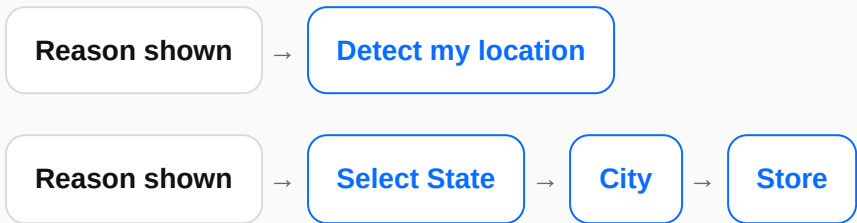
5

Continue

Annotated concept: 2 anchors the price, 3 asks one decision at a time, 4 ties the product to a physical store, 5 makes the purchase method explicit.

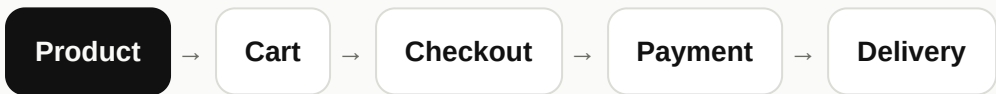
Explain why before asking.

“Select your location to see the best available offer.”



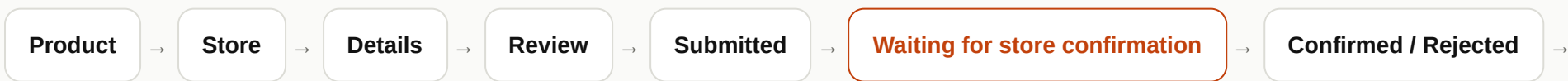
The same reason appears in both branches. Auto-detect is the quick path; manual selection is the fallback. Neither is a surprise permission prompt.

Two journeys, one overlap.



They share the same start, the same product decisions and an eventual payment. They diverge at the moment of commitment, so that's where the choice is surfaced.

“Waiting for store confirmation” is a real screen.



A booking depends on a person at a store, so the system can't answer instantly. If the interface treats it as instant, the customer assumes silence means failure.

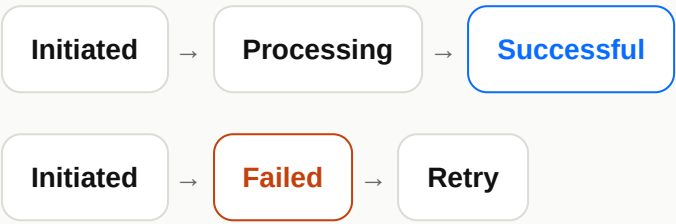
Designing for states, not just the happy path.

The state model I explored during design — not a claim about the backend implementation.

BOOKING



PAYMENT



ORDER



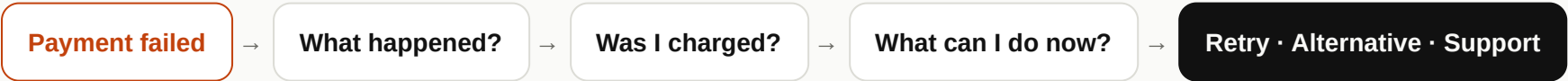
13 — CHECKOUT · 14 — FAILURE · 15 — CONFIRMATION

Ask only when the customer knows why.



The first version looked clean but still made the customer answer too many questions at once. The problem wasn't the number of fields; it was that they didn't yet understand why we were asking.

Payment failure is a recovery journey.



A confirmation that answers “what now?”

Order number

#1

Product & amount

2

Payment status

35

Delivery / pickup & store info

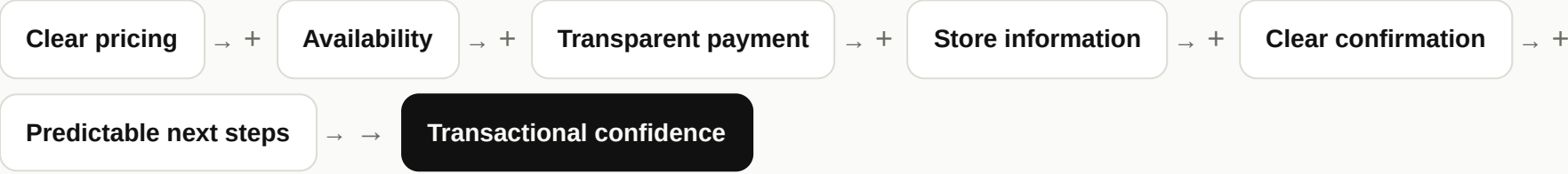
4

Next action

1 Anchor reference · **2** What and how much · **3** Money status, stated plainly · **4** Where and how it arrives · **5** One clear next step.

16 — TRUST · 17 — PRINCIPLES

Trust is the sum of small certainties.



- 01

Explain before asking
Give the reason, then the request.
- 02

Reduce decisions at each step
One question at a time.
- 03

Make transaction states visible
Never leave a customer guessing.
- 04

Design the unhappy path
Failures get their own journeys.
- 05

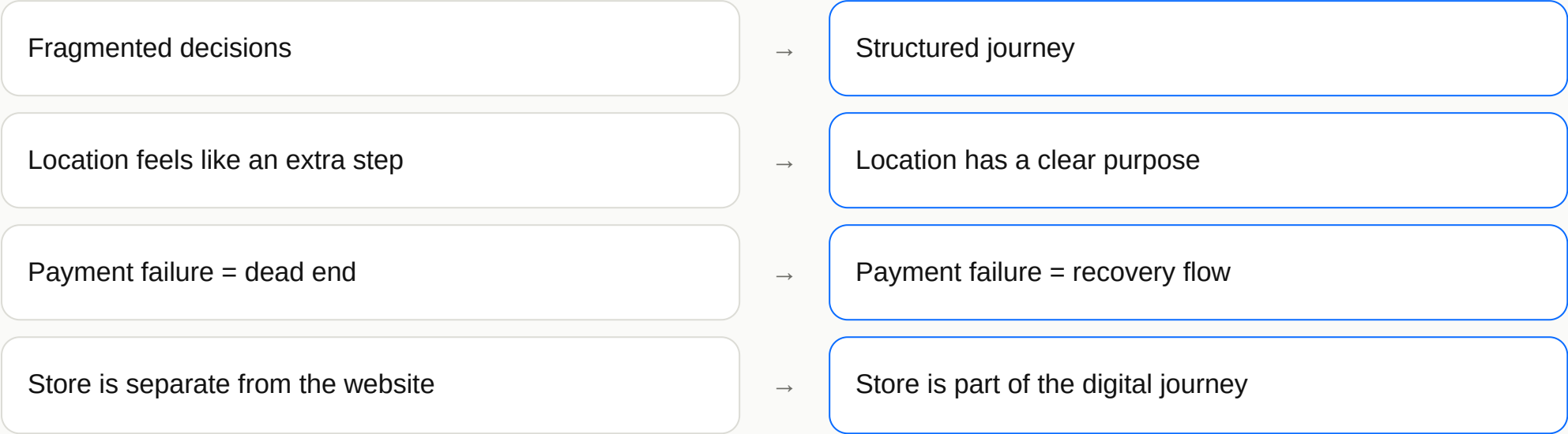
Connect digital and physical
The store is part of the flow.
- 06

Use progressive disclosure
Reveal complexity when it's relevant.

The brief kept getting bigger.

PHASE 01	PHASE 02	PHASE 03	PHASE 04	PHASE 05
Website / visual redesign	Customer journey understanding	Purchase & booking flows	Edge cases & system states	Omnichannel experience

Qualitative comparison. No performance metrics were measured or are claimed here.



It started as a redesign. It became the full journey.

What began as an e-commerce redesign turned into designing the complete customer journey between digital commerce and physical retail.

Good e-commerce UX isn't just about helping someone buy a product. It's about reducing uncertainty from the moment they decide they want something to the moment they know what happens next.

Visuals marked as concept or illustrative are explanatory diagrams, not measured research data.